With annual manufacturing revenues exceeding ₹12,000 crore, the footwear industry in Agra accounts for almost 35 per cent of the total footwear exports from India and caters to 65 per cent of the domestic footwear market. There are around 10,000 footwear manufacturing units in Agra. About 30–35 per cent of Agra's population depends on the leather footwear manufacturing industry that provides employment to nearly 5,00,000 people.

- In Quazipada, Agra, home-based micro units produce over one million pairs of shoes every day. A shoe passes through at least five to six hands before finally reaching the stores. 'A fitter gets ₹20 per shoe while the one who fixes the sole gets paid ₹15 per pair. The one who puts the lace gets ₹4–5 and the man who does the pasting and stitching gets ₹10–15 for every pair. This is the price for a pair of rexine shoes while this gets doubled in the case of leather shoes,' says Taj Ahmed, the owner of one such small unit. 'Nine of my 20 workers have left the job since 8 November. The others simply sit around as I have not been able to source raw material with the limited money I have.'
- A few metres from Agra Fort is Chakki Paat, a densely populated Dalit settlement which produces tens of thousands of shoes every day. 'Ordinarily, we would produce 200 pairs of shoes a day, but it's now down to a few pairs; most days even less.' Sharvan, a Dalit worker in a lace factory in Bijlighar, says, 'The government should have thought about the poor. *Hum soch mein hi aadhe huain jaa rahe hain* (we are worrying ourselves to death).'
- The bigger manufacturing units are no better. About 40 km away in Unnao, processing and manufacturing units are facing similar problems due to shortage of hides. 'Because of inability to run units,' says Taj Alam of Kings International Pvt. Ltd., 'our export orders are being affected and are being diverted to other countries like Indonesia, Sri Lanka, Pakistan, Bangladesh. In the past few